Qandahār was taken and Babur had bestowed Qalāt and the country of Turnūk (Tarnak) on ‘Abdu’r-razzāq Mīrzā. Accordingly, Babur had left him in Qalāt. By this time, the Aūzbegs had completely besieged Qandahār. Babur had no choice, given the fear of Shaybāni Khān, but to return to Kābul. By the time he reached, Babur was all set to march out for Hindustan. He took to opportunity to pass on the charge of Kābul to him.

Now the land of Badakhshān was without a ruler or ruler’s heir. Mīrzā Khān was eager enough to go there. Babur has mentioned in *Baburnama* that it was Mīrzā’s relationship with Shāh Begum,[45] along with her approval, which pushed him to go there. Babur permitted him to go, and the honourable begum too joined him. Babur badly wanted his maternal aunt Mihr-nigār Khānum to be with him as a blood relation, but she too was keen to go to Badakhshān. She went to Badakhshān.

The Second Start for Hindustan

In September of AD 1507 (first Jumada), Babur began to execute the plan of going to Hindustan. They began by marching out of Kābul, taking the road through little Kābul and going down by Sūrkh-rabāṭ to Qūrūq-sāī.

Babur has previously talked of Afghān thieves living between Kābul and Lamghān (Ningnahār), who had caused trouble for long. It had come to Babur’s notice that the thieves’ misdeed had multiplied as they heard of his march towards Hindustan. One fine morning, when Babur and his men marched from Jagdālīk, the Afghans located between it and Lamghān were ready to block the pass. Accordingly, they arrayed on the mountain to the north and advanced with a loud sound of tambour holding shining swords in their hands. As Babur and his men took the pass, he instructed them to keep moving and pushed along the mountainside. The Afghāns stood firm at their ground and were so well organized that they would not let even one arrow fly. They soon took up the fight with Babur’s men.

Babur has not given the details of this fight in the *Baburnama*, but he has hinted that the Afghāns were brutally beaten. Babur’s army brutalized them with an intense shower of arrows. Most Afghāns were caught and brought to Babur, and he ordered the execution of each of them to set an example. Then, he resumed his march and dismounted not before reaching the Adīnapūr-fort in the Nangarhār tūmān.

Babur was clueless about where he would go, camp and stay en route Hindustan. He had just marched up and down, camping in places never heard of